HEART WORDS AT HOME

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

For the grown-up at home. Three minutes a day with one or two words beats twenty minutes once a week.

A **heart word** is a common word that is not spelled the way it sounds, like **said** or **was**. Most of each word still follows the rules your child has been taught. Only the odd part has to be remembered, and that is the part we put a small heart over. Telling a child to "just memorize the whole word" makes it harder, because they stop using the sounds they already know.

THREE MINUTES, FIVE STEPS

1. Say the word. Your child says it back and says how many sounds they hear.
2. They write one letter or letter team per sound in the boxes, left to right.
3. You say which part is the surprise. They draw a small heart above that box.
4. They read the word three times, tapping each box as they say its sound.
5. Cover it. They write the whole word from memory, then check it letter by letter.

THIS WEEK'S TEN WORDS

WORD	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI
the					
of					
was					
said					
you					
are					
they					
from					
have					
one					

Tick a day when your child read the word and wrote it right.

SAY THIS

- "How many sounds? Tap them."
- "Which part is the surprise?"
- "Nearly. Check the middle box."
- "You remembered the heart part."

SKIP THIS

- "Sound it out" for the heart part. It will not work.
- Spelling the word out loud for them to copy.
- More than two new words in one sitting.
- Finishing on a word they got wrong.

Note from the teacher:

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